Torreya nucifera Siebold & Zucc.

Japanese Torreya, Japanese Nutmeg-Yew, Kaya



HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



FRUIT

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Evergreen conifer tree

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: 15–25 m (50–80 ft) tall; broad crown. Slow growing. Trunk to 1.5–2 m diameter in mature specimens

Sun

Water

Soil
Moist, well-drained soils. Acid to neutral soils

Zone 8a
Potentially suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a (hardiness estimated Zones 6–9). Heat and humidity tolerance not extensively documented. Slow growing. Requires good drainage and consistent moisture. Rare in cultivation. Open items for local performance. Wood valued for traditional board games (Go, Shogi)

PLANTING NOTES

Planting
None stated

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Native to southern Japan and South Korea (Jeju Island). Forests and wooded slopes

Form
Evergreen tree with broad crown of wide-spreading branches. Dense, expanding from conical to dome-shaped with age. Subdioecious

Foliage
Linear, needle-like leaves 2–3.5 cm long, stiff, dark green above with two whitish stomatal bands below. Spirally arranged but twisted to appear pectinate.
Unpleasantly aromatic when crushed. Sharp-pointed tips

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Light reddish-brown when young, peeling in flakes, aging to grayish-brown with fissures

HEALTH

Health
Generally few problems stated. Like other Taxaceae relatives, toxic if ingested (seeds require processing). Root rot possible in poorly drained soils. No serious pests noted in botanical

Symptoms
None stated